PROJECT REPORT 5

Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Part A: Case Study

For this part, I prepared a case study on phishing. Phishing is a type of cybercrime where attackers trick people into sharing sensitive information such as passwords, OTPs, bank details, or login credentials by pretending to be a trusted source.

In the case study, I described:

- What phishing is
- How it happens step-by-step
- Who is usually targeted
- What consequences victims may face

The case study used a realistic student-related example to explain how phishing attacks can happen through fake emails, suspicious links, and fraudulent websites. This project helped me understand that phishing is dangerous because it often looks genuine and creates panic or urgency.

Part B: Prevention Checklist

For the second part, I created a Stay Safe Online Checklist containing practical safety tips relevant to college students in India.

The checklist included:

- Strong password usage
- Two-factor authentication
- Avoiding suspicious links
- Protecting personal data
- Safe app downloads
- Public Wi-Fi precautions
- UPI safety tips
- Reporting cybercrime through official channels

I also included the official reporting channels:

- National Cyber Crime Portal: cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930

This activity helped me understand how simple precautions can prevent major cyber frauds, especially in banking and UPI transactions.

Learning Outcomes:

Through this project, I learned:

- What phishing is and how it works
- How cybercriminals manipulate people through fake messages and websites
- The importance of online awareness and verification
- Practical ways to stay safe online
- The correct reporting channels for cybercrime in India

Reflection: -

What surprised me most while researching this topic was how simple and believable phishing attacks can be. I realized that cybercriminals do not always rely on advanced hacking techniques; instead, they often succeed by creating panic, urgency, or trust. Even educated people and students can become victims if they click on a fake link or share an OTP without thinking carefully. This made me understand that awareness is one of the strongest forms of protection against cybercrime.

As a result of this project, one habit I will personally change is that I will carefully verify links, emails, and UPI requests before taking any action. I will no longer respond quickly to urgent-looking digital messages without checking their authenticity first. This habit can help me stay safer online and avoid financial or personal data loss.